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The RICE Prioritization Model

Stop arguing about gut feeling. Start ranking priorities you can defend.

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R -- Reach

How many people or accounts are directly affected by this initiative? Is this something that touches one client, or many? A fix that helps a single account, however loudly they're asking for it, scores differently than one that touches a whole segment -- Reach forces that distinction into the open instead of letting the loudest voice win by default.

I -- Impact

How much difference will it make -- to revenue, trust, or retention -- if this works? Impact is deliberately separated from Reach because a narrow-reach initiative can still be high-impact (a fix that saves one enterprise account worth millions), and a wide-reach one can be low-impact (a cosmetic change everyone sees but nobody cares about).

C -- Confidence

How certain are we that this will actually work as planned -- are we relying on solid evidence, or an educated guess dressed up as a plan? Confidence is what keeps Impact honest: it's easy to claim a huge impact for an idea nobody has actually tested.

E -- Effort

How much time and resource does it take to execute, realistically, including the parts that always take longer than expected? Effort is the denominator that turns a good idea into a good use of a specific week's capacity.

Using It Under Pressure

RICE is most valuable exactly when a team disagrees about what to prioritize under time pressure -- a competitive threat, a renewal at risk, a limited-bandwidth technical team split across multiple demands. Scoring each option against all four factors, in order, turns a gut-feeling argument into a rankable, defensible sequence that survives being questioned by someone who wasn't in the room when the decision was made.

What It's Not For

RICE is a prioritization tool, not a strategy tool -- it ranks options that are already on the table, it doesn't generate them. Used well, it comes after the harder work of identifying what the real options actually are, not as a substitute for that thinking.

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About the Author

David Maika is a Customer Success professional with experience spanning customer operations, process improvement, CRM implementation, project management, and business strategy. His work focuses on helping organizations improve customer outcomes, strengthen operational efficiency, and build scalable systems that support long-term growth.

Through practical frameworks, real-world case studies, and modern AI-assisted workflows, he aims to make Customer Success knowledge accessible, actionable, and valuable for professionals at every stage of their careers.

To learn more, access additional resources, or connect professionally, visit davidmaika.com or linkedin.com/in/davidmaika.

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